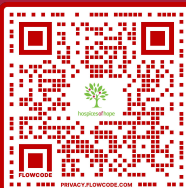


Your impact in 2022



hospicesofhope
making every day count
USA

**Supporting and developing
hospice care in Southeast Europe**



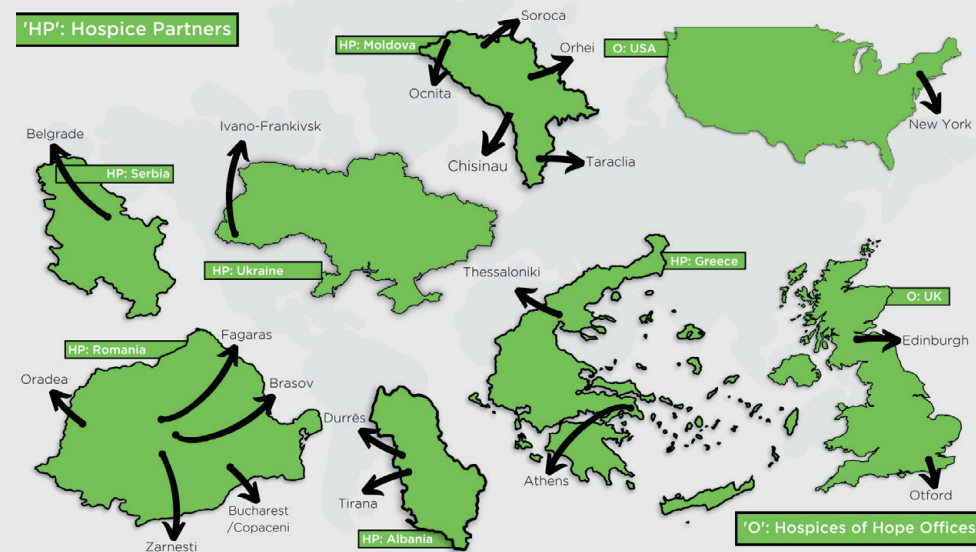
Visit our website
and find out more

**Because everyone deserves to live and die
with dignity and without pain**

www.hospicesofhope.com

Locations of our hospice partners and offices

Hospices of Hope's current hospice partner charities are in:
Albania, Greece, Republic of Moldova, Romania, Serbia and Ukraine.



*This map is not to scale and only a guide to our country partners and locations

Our vision

Hospices of Hope is a US and UK charity dedicated to supporting the development of hospice/palliative care services in Southeast Europe. Our vision is for all patients to have free of charge access to specialist end of life or palliative care - because everyone deserves to live and die with dignity and without pain.

Together with local organizations in our partner countries, we strive to promote hospice and palliative care in the region through providing advocacy, technical expertise, training, and funding. We work with governments to improve legislation, widen access to services and increase the resources available. All deserve access to help when they desperately need it.

Front Cover Image - Nurse Ljubica of BELhospice in Serbia caring for patient Radmila

Message from the UK CEO

- Anna Perolls



2022 has been a year of both challenge and celebration as we have navigated the rapidly changing landscape of the world around us.

As we begin this new year, I invite you first of all to look back and celebrate how we have made an impact in 2022.

Hospices of Hope remains the only charity dedicated to the development of palliative care in Southeast Europe. This has meant we have been in a unique position to respond to new crises as they have emerged - particularly the conflict that has engulfed Ukraine.

It was a privilege to support our country partners in Romania and Moldova as they provided emergency accommodation and medical care to Ukrainian refugees fleeing the war. And thanks to the incredible response of our supporters, our Help for Ukraine Appeal meant we could very swiftly send an ambulance and a generator to the Ivano-Frankivsk Regional Palliative Care Center, as well as send them vital drug supplies and other materials. The generator especially has become vital for them in the wake of Russian attacks on energy infrastructure.

We were also able to initiate new projects in the Republic of Moldova and Serbia.

2022 also saw the return of many of our regular events. Our summer trip program took place for the first time since 2019,

the volunteers on the importance of our work, and the work of our country partners. Five weeks of joy, laughter and special memories brought patients and family hope and respite.

On behalf of all the Hospices of Hope Teams, and our country partners, thank you for championing us. Your generosity, love and support made 2022 a very successful year.



Anna

Anna Perolls, CEO



Anna with patients, staff and volunteers taking part in the Bucharest Holiday Club at Copaceni

Why is Hospices of Hope needed?

The Archbishop of Canterbury in his New Year's message said:
"caring goes to the heart of what it means to be human. It's hard, but it can also be the most life-giving thing we ever do."

Hospices of Hope has a vital role to play in continuing its role to develop better access to palliative care services in the region, through the use of its knowledge, advocacy skills, fundraising, and networking experience. Medical professionals and other key individuals in the region are very keen to benefit from the experience of the US and UK in developing hospice services, and particularly grateful for any funding that can help them pioneer and grow their services.

Our country partners receive on average less than 30% of their overall budget, and often the money provided is only for specific services. Our hospice partner in Romania, Hospice Casa Sperantei, is still the only organization in the country that provides the whole

range of palliative care services for both adults and children: in-patient care, day care, out-patient clinics and bereavement services. However, thanks largely to the palliative care training programs run at their Princess Diana Palliative Care Education Center, there are now more than 100 organizations in Romania that offer some elements of palliative care.

It is indeed sometimes hard to work in this region, which has so many challenges socially, economically and politically. However, it is an enormous privilege to be able to make a difference in the lives of some of the most disadvantaged citizens in Europe.

The Prica Family - Serbia

Life is full of daily challenges for the three-member Prica family. Their young child, V*, suffers from the most severe form of cerebral-palsy, spastic quadriplegia, which is a severely life-limiting illness.

It affects both arms and legs, as well as the torso and face. Children with spastic quadriplegia usually cannot walk, and the overarching cause is brain damage before, during or shortly after birth. They require lifetime support in order to have a good quality of life.

And yet, until BELhospice came along, this family had been completely unsupported and invisible in the Serbian health system.

The family live on the third floor of a building that has no lift, but V is immobile and requires the use of a wheelchair. The lack of lift requires his family to carry him all the time, but as V grows this is becoming more and more difficult and they have to stay at home.

"We try to get everything we can from the Fund for Health Care, but it's nowhere near enough to help us. We don't receive

what we need to look after V. I have the impression that the needs of such children [like V] are not considered."

Through the care and support of the BELhospice team, V's family finally feel visible to others. **"I feel calmer now, because I know that when V gets sick I can get in touch straight away with Dr Marija [from BELhospice] and get the right advice, instead of waiting for hours to be seen at the hospital."**

For the first time the family has also received psycho-social support – with even just the simple questions like "how are you doing" and "how can we help" making the world of difference.

"We now feel safe thanks to BELhospice, because we know we have someone to turn to in our hour of need. Because there are people who will do their best to help us. This feeling is priceless."

**Initial used for privacy*

Reporting back...

Your support has helped our country partners to care for 7,866 patients throughout 2022 and to achieve the following:

UK:

To continue to raise funds to assist the development of palliative care services in South East Europe. To reinstate the summer trips by sending volunteers from the UK to Romania and Serbia.

In 2022 we were able to fulfill all our pledges to our network partners. Although it was an unpredictable year, we were able to continue our mission to raise funds so that our country partners could operate successfully throughout 2022.

This year also saw the successful return of our summer trips programme after the pandemic. Across 5 weeks, 64 volunteers took part to help 138 beneficiaries. The trips provide children with rare and life limiting illnesses, and their families, the opportunity for some respite. Dates for our 2023 trips are now available. If you or someone you know would be interested, please do visit our website to find out more.

South East Europe:

Help to adapt services and local fund raising to the post-Covid environment, taking into account lessons learned and resources available.

Thanks to modern technology our hospice partners have been able to extend their reach to patients outside their normal geographical area. This support will continue post-pandemic, meaning that patients in areas that are not served by hospice services can still benefit from advice and video/telephone support.

Romania:

Help to get the services fully opened at the Children's Center in Copaceni.

Despite the challenges and human and financial pressures, Hospice Casa Sperantei has continued to grow and develop, and celebrated a milestone 30 year anniversary in 2022. There is currently no other medical foundation in Romania that has had the impact that Hospice Casa Sperantei has.

The respite center at Adunatii Copaceni is now fully operational, meaning additional help can be offered to families needing support. Copaceni has also been vital in helping to house Ukrainian refugees, either temporarily or longer-term.

The children and staff were delighted to receive visits from our patron, Marius Iepure this year, as well as long-standing supporter and celebrated tenor, Neil Latchman. Both provided wonderful performances and encouraged the children to get involved.



Patron Marius Iepure visits Copaceni

Serbia:

Help establish the first children's palliative care team.

Historically, children with cancer have been treated at the pediatric oncology unit and Mother and Child institute in Belgrade. But children suffering from other life-limiting illnesses rarely benefit from any specialist facility or services. When a child gets sick and the parent/s are finding it hard to cope, it is often sadly suggested by the health authorities to institutionalize the child.

In 2022 BELhospice set up the first ever children's palliative care service – a multidisciplinary home-care team, through a grant secured from St James' Place Foundation which covered most of the first year's running costs. Training for the specialist children's team took place in April organized by Hospices of Hope.

There is still some stigma surrounding palliative care in Serbia, with parents not wanting their children to receive it as they associate it with end of life care rather than specialist holistic care. Hospices of Hope and BELhospice continue to work to change this perception.

Moldova:

Continue to support the national palliative care network in 5 locations in Moldova.

Hospices of Hope was fortunate to secure a 3-year funding grant through Medicor Foundation, commencing in 2022, to continue support of the 5 home care teams in Moldova. This grant was awarded on the basis that we would continue our fundraising efforts. Thanks to a grant from the Burdett Nursing Trust, we were also able to employ a specialist nurse trainer, who will be crucial in training new nurses and raising the standards of palliative care in the country.

One of the biggest obstacles to accessing health services in Moldova is public transport. We were able to obtain funding from the Beatitudes Fund, which helped Hospices of Hope Moldova



The Hospices of Hope Moldova team and day centre patients pictured with their new minibus

acquire a minibus. The minibus collects patients from remote regions and brings them to the center in Orhei. This has meant more patients have had the opportunity to join the day therapy sessions and consultations, receiving the care they desperately need.

Additionally, we helped to open the first ever palliative day center and out-patient clinic in Moldova. The President of Moldova had personally arranged for the donation of the equipment needed, and the Minister of Health gave a keynote speech at the opening. The Minister of Health was so impressed that she wants to see the center replicated in other regions of Moldova. A grant has been secured to open a Palliative Day Center in the capital, Chisinau, in 2023.

Albania:

Continue to build the capacity of the palliative care network.

As one of the poorest countries in Europe, fundraising within Albania is virtually non-existent. They do not receive any state funding for palliative care services, aside from the reimbursement of costs for some medicine. Therefore, the best way we can support Ryder Albania is by helping them with long term stability as well as fundraising in the country.

Hospices of Hope arranged a training program in October entitled "Advanced Palliative Care" which the Albanian teams found positive and useful in expanding their knowledge and work going forward.

A grant has been secured to help sustain the services during the next 3 years.

Kosovo:

Research opportunities for working with the government to establish palliative care in Kosovo.

Initial meetings have taken place this year to discuss how Hospices of Hope can assist with training and establishing a palliative care structure in the country. Talks are ongoing.

Greece:

Raise funds amongst the Greek community to enable small and struggling palliative care services in the country to function.

This year the focus has been on understanding the needs of each of our Greek country partners, Merimna (for children) and Nosilia (for adults). Our founder, Graham, visited the country earlier in the year and was able to meet with members of our network teams there.

With Hospices of Hope's support, our partners Merimna have been able to take on a 3rd palliative care nurse and Nosilia are extremely grateful for our help with funding and connections.

Palliative care is still not recognized as a medical specialty by the Greek Ministry of Health and charitable giving is still not widely embraced by the general population, which presents some challenges.

Ukraine:

Responding to the needs as a result of the war.

In May we launched the Help for Ukraine Appeal, in response to the devastating impact of the Russian invasion. We took the time to look into how we could best help, and began the appeal to raise funds to directly support Ukrainians through our country partners in Romania and Moldova. Hospice Casa Sperantei provided emergency accommodation at Adunatii Copaceni and admitted a number of Ukrainian patients to the hospice in Bucharest. The teams in Moldova provided medical aid to refugees.

In addition, we were also able to officially partner with the Ivano-Frankivsk Regional Palliative Care Centre in Western Ukraine, whom we have been in contact with for many years after a number of the staff were trained at the Hospice Education Centre in Brasov. We aim to continue to support them through ongoing funding and development. Once the conflict is resolved we know the aftermath will be vast, and continued support and assistance will be crucial.

Thanks to the Appeal and our collaboration

with the Blue Heron Foundation, Hospices of Hope was able to send them an ambulance so that they can transport terminally ill patients to Ivano-Frankivsk from the east of Ukraine, where the fighting was the most intense. We were also able to supply them with a much needed generator and vital drugs and medical supplies. Next year we hope to help them with renovations needed in order to equip them to deal with the huge demands for palliative care.

"Adunatii-Copaceni will stay in my heart for ever. It's impossible to forget the amazing nature of the hospice. But the biggest wealth of this fairy-tale place is its people – all of you working here. Your love, care and warmth were presented to every refugee. And I want to express boundless gratitude to all the sponsors – with Graham Perolls at the head – for the excellent facilities and good conditions created for our full stay. Special thanks to Monica, the medical sister who saved my sister from illness, who kept our blood pressure under control and helped with medicines." - Nataly, a Ukrainian refugee staying at Copaceni.

THANK YOU TO EVERYONE THAT HELPED US TO ACHIEVE THESE GOALS

US Update

2022 was a successful year for Hospices of Hope's retail operation. We now have 15 shops which are located in the following areas:

Biggin Hill, Carshalton, East Grinstead, Faversham, Gorgie (Edinburgh), Maidstone, Newington (Edinburgh), Orpington, Otford, Pimlico, Reigate, Rochester, Tonbridge, Tunbridge Wells and Waterloo.



Our Tonbridge shop was relocated in 2022 to a more prominent location and was officially opened by the Mayor of Tonbridge and antiques expert, Catherine Southon.

In 2023, we are aiming to open a new shop in Westerham, Kent.

Our retail offering has also expanded online, with hand selected items being sold on re-sale platforms such as Vinted and eBay.

The Olive Tree Bistro & Tea room, located in Otford, continues to operate successfully since its opening in 2021.

Scan to find out more about our shops and their opening hours

Message from our US Chair of Trustees

- Julianne Johnson Paunescu



2022 was another year that saw Hospices of Hope (HoH) show its resilience and flexibility. We remain the only charity dedicated to the development of palliative care in Southeast Europe which placed HoH in a unique position to respond to the conflict in Ukraine and its spillover effect in neighboring countries where we work. Our country partners in Romania and Moldova found themselves having to shift gears almost overnight to provide emergency accommodation and medical care to refugees fleeing the war. They couldn't have done it without your help! U.S. donors gave over \$50,000 in 2022 toward this effort and a grant from the California based Blue Heron Fund covered the cost of a much needed ambulance for a hospice in Ukraine to help move patients to safety from the hardest hit areas. HoH signed a memorandum of understanding with the Ivano-Frankivsk Regional Palliative Care Center in Ukraine in August, so they are now our official partner. In a recent conversation, our country manager in Ukraine expressed his hope that during the tragedies of the war that we see play out every day we wouldn't forget those in need of palliative care.

Although the crisis in Ukraine has certainly been a focus, HoH continues to make progress in all of the regional countries in which it works. Your donations allowed us to give over \$70,000 to those programs in 2022.

With the Covid crisis easing, events in the U.S. also returned in 2022 and we were happy to see old friends and make some new ones. A screening of "The Wishing Tree," a film produced in partnership with Netflix based on our Copaceni hospice, was held at the Romanian Ambassador's residence in Washington in May. The British Consul General in New York City hosted a spring reception and other supporters hosted an Autumn Soiree in Manhattan. Over \$10,000 for Copaceni and our efforts in Ukraine was raised at these events.

I became involved with Hospices of Hope in 2007 after a family member in Romania died from a very painful cancer with no palliative care provided and little guidance for the family. I hoped that hospice care was available somewhere in Romania and pledged to support it if so, in order that other families could have a different experience. I found Hospices of Hope online and contacted the office in New York. It has been a privilege to play a small role in this work to bring comfort to patients and their families in Southeast Europe. Thank you for walking alongside our teams and our patients and their families as we continue this journey to change the face of dying in Southeast Europe forever.



Julianne Johnson Paunescu

Chair of Trustees



Highlights from some of our fundraising events in 2022

Evening at the British Residence

The first event to fall victim to Covid was a reception hosted at the British Consul General's residence overlooking the United Nations Plaza in New York. After several attempts, we were finally able to have the reception in April. Then Deputy Consul General Hannah Young hosted a very successful gathering where we were able to reconnect with long time supporters and get acquainted with some new ones. New York Philharmonic

clarinetist Pascual Martinez-Forteza, joined by his wife Gema Niento-Forteza on piano, performed. Our founder, Graham Perolls, and Mirela Nemtanu, CEO of Hospice Casa Sperantei in Romania, shared information on their current work. Attendees also watched a short film by hospice supporter John Florescu about the Ukrainian refugee situation and how our teams have helped meet the needs of refugees fleeing the war zone. Thank you to the British Consul staff and all of you who attended!



Founder Graham Perolls with supporters at the British Residence event in April in New York.



(left) Romanian Ambassador Andrei Muraru with Trevor Cook at the screening of "The Wishing Tree" at his residence in Washington D.C. (right) Board chair Julianne Paunescu welcomes guests to the screening.



The Wishing Tree Film Screening

In May, we were very excited to have a screening of "The Wishing Tree," Romania's first film made to benefit a charity. The screening was hosted by Romanian Ambassador to the U.S. Andrei Muraru and held at his residence. Produced in cooperation with Netflix, the film tells the story of Mara, a 12-year-old girl diagnosed with cancer, who embarks on a magical adventure filled with hope. Filmed at our children's respite center at Copaceni outside Bucharest, the movie was made to benefit Casa Soerantei and gives an incredible insight into what it means to live with a life-

threatening condition. The audience was clearly very moved and Ambassador Moraru congratulated us on the movie and thanked us for our work in Romania. After a period of cinema screenings, the film is now available on Romanian Netflix and we look forward to hosting more screenings this fall across the U.S. We thank the ambassador and embassy staff for hosting a wonderful evening where we met many new supporters from the Romanian community in Washington. We also are very grateful for the generous donors who contributed to our work at Copaceni as well toward meeting the extra costs we have incurred hosting Ukrainian refugee families at the facility.



A scene from our Autumn Soirée in New York hosted in November, 2022.

Autumn Soirée

November 2022 saw our first Autumn Soirée, graciously hosted for us by Juliana Dancanet and Raluca Gold-Fuchs, two of our Romanian supporters in New York City. Attendees enjoyed a wonderful piano performance by Sorin Frisan, a Romanian pianist based in New York, and we raised over \$6,000 for Copaceni. A special thanks to Juliana and her husband Denis Dancanet and Raluca Gold-Fuchs for hosting such a wonderful event on our behalf!

Our network priorities in 2023

- UK & U.S.

To continue to provide advocacy, technical expertise, training and funding to assist the development of palliative care services in Southeast Europe through our growing network of supporters in the UK & U.S.

- South East Europe

Our aim is to help our partners achieve their main priorities and focus areas for 2023 as follows:

📍 Serbia

BELhospice is continuing to work on the development of their children's palliative home care project. Alongside this, they are looking into the idea of a 'Cottage Hospice' which is a 'home from home' space allowing families to stay together and care for their loved one in their final days. The team is also working to develop programs for adolescents and is seeking our advice and help to further these aims.

📍 Moldova

Hospices of Hope Moldova plan to strengthen palliative care nursing in the country with the help of a senior nurse educator who will provide training, support and advocacy in the region. They are also working to open a day center in the capital city, Chisinau.

📍 Romania

Hospice Casa Sperantei is working to sustain the future of the organization after a difficult year following the start of the war in Ukraine. Their aim is also to develop their facilities further by adding an 8 bed in-patient unit to Copaceni and developing a new building at

the Brasov site to accommodate the growing need. Their focus in 2023 is to raise funds for both of these to be built and operated from 2023 onwards.

Hospice Emmanuel is prioritising recruitment of a full time fundraiser to help run their campaigns to fund 6 clinical team members previously supported by a grant which comes to an end in December 2023, and create an appeal to help build their Hospice Center in Oradea.

📍 Albania

As well as sustaining their existing services in Tirana and Durrës, the team is looking to open a day care center and an information hub for patients to be able to use.

📍 Greece

Our partner Nosilia is looking to relocate to a larger office and warehouse space, as well as to fund an additional palliative care team to include nurses, doctors, a psychologist and physiotherapist.

The Merimna team's focus is to recruit a full time social worker and to develop a pediatric palliative day care center.

📍 Ukraine

The Regional Center of Palliative Care Ivano-Frankivsk is planning to renovate its existing hospice building to increase beds in order to accommodate growing demand. The last renovation was done in 2005.

The state has not provided an increase in funding due to the war, so support is more vital than ever.

Thank you

We would like to thank all our supporters, donors, and foundations who have given so generously to help our patients with terminal or life-limiting illness.

Hospices of Hope USA

1740 Broadway, 15th Floor New
York, NY 10019

T. 646-222-6739

raluca@hospicesofhope.co.uk
www.hospicesofhope.com

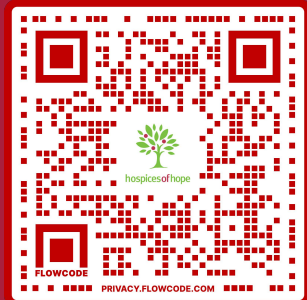
Hospices of Hope UK

11 High Street, Otford,
Kent TN14 5PG

T. +44 (0)1959 525 110

office@hospicesofhope.co.uk
www.hospicesofhope.co.uk

Scan the QR code and
donate today!



hospicesofhope
making every day count

**Registered Charity
Number:**

US EIN Number – 13-4194283

**Hospices of Hope US is a
501(c)3 not for profit
organization**

www.hospicesofhope.com